



Summer Opportunities for High School Students

A directory of pre-college, arts, STEM, leadership, research, internship, and adventure programs.

How to use this directory

Programs are grouped by area of interest. Each entry lists the eligible grade levels, where the program takes place, whether students live on campus or commute, and how long it runs. Program details and deadlines change every year — confirm everything on the program's own website before applying, and talk with your school counselor about cost, fit, and financial aid.

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General Academics at a College or University

American University

GRADES 9-12 • RESIDENTIAL / COMMUTER • MID-ATLANTIC • LENGTH VARIES

Pre-college courses in communication, international studies, and politics that use Washington, D.C. as the classroom.

<https://www.american.edu/summer/>

Babson College

GRADES 10-11 • RESIDENTIAL • NEW ENGLAND • 2 WEEKS

Residential summer study for rising juniors and seniors building business knowledge and entrepreneurial skills.

<https://www.babson.edu/summer-at-babson/high-school-learners/summer-study/>

Boston University

GRADES 9-12 • RESIDENTIAL / COMMUTER • NEW ENGLAND • LENGTH VARIES

A portfolio of summer high school programs exploring new subjects alongside college life in Boston.

<https://www.bu.edu/summer/high-school-programs/>

Brandeis University

GRADES 10-12 • RESIDENTIAL • NEW ENGLAND • LENGTH VARIES

Residential precollege programs for academic and artistic exploration in a diverse global community.

<https://www.brandeis.edu/precollege/>

Brown University

GRADES 9-12 • RESIDENTIAL / COMMUTER / ONLINE • NEW ENGLAND • LENGTH VARIES

More than 300 courses across sessions of one to seven weeks, on campus, online, and abroad.

<https://precollege.brown.edu/>

Bucknell University

GRADES 11-12 • RESIDENTIAL • MID-ATLANTIC • 1 WEEK

BASE: a week living like a college student, taking classes with Bucknell professors on real-world problems.

<https://www.bucknell.edu/admissions-aid/plan-visit/camps-conferences-visit-programs/bucknell-academy-summer-experience-base>

Carleton College

GRADES 10 • RESIDENTIAL • MIDWEST • 1 WEEK • NO COST

Carleton Liberal Arts Experience (CLAE): 52 students attend an all-expenses-paid week of liberal arts courses.

<https://www.carleton.edu/admissions/visit/clae/>

Carnegie Mellon University

GRADES 10–11 • RESIDENTIAL • MID-ATLANTIC • 5+ WEEKS

Pre-College programs taught by CMU faculty, with campus life and the city of Pittsburgh included.

<https://www.cmu.edu/pre-college/>

College of William & Mary

GRADES 10–12 • RESIDENTIAL / COMMUTER / ONLINE • SOUTH • LENGTH VARIES

A wide variety of pre-college programs introducing students to college-level academics.

<https://www.wm.edu/academics/precollege/>

Columbia University

GRADES 9–12 • RESIDENTIAL / COMMUTER / ONLINE • NY METRO & WESTCHESTER • 3 WEEKS

Intensive courses for high school students in New York City, or three-week programs in Barcelona or Jordan.

<https://precollege.sps.columbia.edu/highschool>

Cornell University

GRADES 10–12 • RESIDENTIAL / ONLINE • NY METRO & WESTCHESTER • 3 WEEKS

Summer College: three or six weeks earning college credit in courses taught by Cornell faculty.

<https://sce.cornell.edu/precollege>

Drew University

GRADES 11–12 • ONLINE • LENGTH VARIES

Online college classes alongside undergraduates in subjects from anthropology and business to theatre.

<https://drew.edu/academic/continuing-education-non-degree-programs/summer-programs/summer-term/>

Drexel University

GRADES 9–12 • RESIDENTIAL / COMMUTER • MID-ATLANTIC • LENGTH VARIES

Faculty-led workshops using Drexel's labs and facilities alongside the resources of Philadelphia.

<https://drexel.edu/academics/pre-college-programs/summer-institutes>

Duke University

GRADES 9–12 • RESIDENTIAL / ONLINE • SOUTH • LENGTH VARIES

Credit and enrichment courses with Duke faculty, plus a full residential activity program.

<https://learnmore.duke.edu/precollege/all-programs>

Emory University

GRADES 10–11 • RESIDENTIAL • SOUTH • 2 WEEKS

Rising juniors and seniors study with leading faculty, enroll with college students, and earn transferable credit.

<https://precollege.emory.edu/>

Fordham University

GRADES 11–12 • RESIDENTIAL / COMMUTER / ONLINE • NY METRO & WESTCHESTER • LENGTH VARIES

Credit and non-credit courses in STEM, humanities, social sciences, business, and the arts in New York City.

<https://www.fordham.edu/summer-session/pre-college-programs/>

George Washington University

GRADES 9–12 • RESIDENTIAL / COMMUTER / ONLINE • MID-ATLANTIC • LENGTH VARIES

On-campus courses, study abroad, institute courses, and flexible online and evening classes.

<https://summer.gwu.edu/>

Georgetown University

GRADES 9–11 • RESIDENTIAL / COMMUTER / ONLINE • MID-ATLANTIC • LENGTH VARIES

Live on campus and attend classes with college students plus Washington, D.C. guest speakers.

<https://summer.georgetown.edu/>

Gettysburg College

GRADES 10–12 • RESIDENTIAL • MID-ATLANTIC • 1 WEEK

Week-long camps led by faculty in psychology, creative writing, civic engagement, Civil War era studies, and sports.

<https://www.gettysburg.edu/offices/conference-event-services/summer-programs>

Harvard University

AGES 15–18 • RESIDENTIAL / COMMUTER / ONLINE • NEW ENGLAND • LENGTH VARIES

Secondary School Program and pre-college sessions designed to prepare students academically and socially for college.

<https://www.summer.harvard.edu/high-school-programs>

Ithaca College

AGES 15–18 • RESIDENTIAL • NY METRO & WESTCHESTER • LENGTH VARIES

Residential Summer College with college-level courses designed and reserved for pre-college students.

<https://www.ithaca.edu/summer-college-high-school-students>

Johns Hopkins Center for Talented Youth

GRADES 9–12 • RESIDENTIAL / ONLINE • MID-ATLANTIC • LENGTH VARIES

CTY summer programs offer challenging academic work for advanced students among academically similar peers.

<https://cty.jhu.edu/programs/summer/>

Manhattan University

GRADES 9–12 • RESIDENTIAL / COMMUTER • NY METRO & WESTCHESTER • LENGTH VARIES

Pre-college programs exploring academic interests and campus life with New York City nearby.

<https://manhattan.edu/academics/schools-and-departments/scps/non-credit-programs/pre-college/index.php>

Marist College

GRADES 11–12 • RESIDENTIAL • NY METRO & WESTCHESTER • 2 WEEKS

Summer Institutes of two to four weeks in the Hudson River Valley, Florence, Italy, or both.

<https://www.marist.edu/admission/summer-pre-college>

Miami University (Ohio)

GRADES 11–12 • RESIDENTIAL • MIDWEST • 2 WEEKS

Summer Scholars: a two-week intensive academic module plus college admission, test prep, and essay workshops.

<https://miamioh.edu/admission/high-school/summer-scholars/>

Northeastern University

GRADES 9–12 • RESIDENTIAL / ONLINE • NEW ENGLAND • LENGTH VARIES

Accelerate pre-college programs hosted on Northeastern's campuses and led by its faculty.

<https://precollegeprograms.northeastern.edu/>

Northwestern University

AGES 15–17 • RESIDENTIAL / COMMUTER / ONLINE • MIDWEST • LENGTH VARIES

College Preparation Program, Center for Talent Development, National High School Institute, and sports camps.

<https://sps.northwestern.edu/pre-college/>

NYU

GRADES 9–12 • RESIDENTIAL / COMMUTER / ONLINE • NY METRO & WESTCHESTER • LENGTH VARIES

Programs from one to six weeks with varied requirements, deadlines, housing, and financial aid options.

<https://www.nyu.edu/admissions/high-school-programs.html>

Quinnipiac University

GRADES 9–12 • RESIDENTIAL / COMMUTER / ONLINE • NEW ENGLAND • LENGTH VARIES

A growing list of summer programs, camps, and undergraduate courses across all schools and colleges.

<https://www.qu.edu/summer/>

Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute

GRADES 10–11 • RESIDENTIAL • NY METRO & WESTCHESTER • LENGTH VARIES

PREFACE introduces students to the fields of engineering through design and manufacturing challenges.

<https://pre-college.admissions.rpi.edu/>

Rutgers University

GRADES 9–12 • RESIDENTIAL / COMMUTER / ONLINE • MID-ATLANTIC • LENGTH VARIES

Credit and non-credit pre-college programs at Rutgers–New Brunswick for motivated high school students.

<https://precollegesummer.rutgers.edu/>

Skidmore College

GRADES 10–12 • RESIDENTIAL • NY METRO & WESTCHESTER • 5+ WEEKS

Five weeks of college-level study, living and learning with students from across the country and abroad.

<https://www.skidmore.edu/precollege/about/index.php>

Smith College

GRADES 9–12 • RESIDENTIAL • NEW ENGLAND • LENGTH VARIES

Precollege programs for high school girls, with hands-on classes and a recommendation from Smith faculty.

<https://www.smith.edu/academics/precollege-programs>

Stanford University

AGES 16–19 • RESIDENTIAL / COMMUTER • WEST COAST • 5+ WEEKS

High School Summer College: eight weeks enrolled as a visiting undergraduate in Stanford's Summer Quarter.

<https://summercollege.stanford.edu/>

Stevens Institute of Technology

GRADES 11–12 • RESIDENTIAL / COMMUTER • NY METRO & WESTCHESTER • LENGTH VARIES

Build something start to finish — a business plan, video game, investment portfolio, or short animation.

<https://www.stevens.edu/admissions/pre-college-programs>

Syracuse University

GRADES 9–11 • RESIDENTIAL / ONLINE • NY METRO & WESTCHESTER • LENGTH VARIES

Summer College, running more than 50 years, partners with departments across the university.

<https://summercollege.syr.edu/>

The Cooper Union

GRADES 9–12 • COMMUTER • NY METRO & WESTCHESTER • LENGTH VARIES

Summer STEM, writing, art intensive, and introduction to architecture programs in Manhattan.

<https://cooper.edu/academics/outreach-and-pre-college>

The New School / Parsons

GRADES 9–12 • RESIDENTIAL / COMMUTER / ONLINE • NY METRO & WESTCHESTER • LENGTH VARIES

Develop a talent in art, design, performing arts, or liberal arts while experiencing university life in New York.

<https://cpe.newschool.edu/youth-and-pre-college/parsons-academy-summer-programs/>

The Rockefeller University

AGES 16+ • COMMUTER • NY METRO & WESTCHESTER • LENGTH VARIES

Hands-on, mentored science for students plus workshops for teachers, in Manhattan.

<https://www.rockefeller.edu/outreach/>

Tufts University

GRADES 9–12 • RESIDENTIAL / COMMUTER / ONLINE • NEW ENGLAND • LENGTH VARIES

Tufts Summer Study offers college-level courses, specialized programs, and college application prep.

<https://universitycollege.tufts.edu/pre-college>

UC San Diego

GRADES 9–12 • RESIDENTIAL • WEST COAST • 2 WEEKS

Summer Springboard: a two-week program on the UCSD campus with college prep workshops and academic excursions.

<https://summerspringboard.com/lp/ucsd-campus/>

UCLA

GRADES 9–12 • RESIDENTIAL / COMMUTER • WEST COAST • 1 WEEK

One to three weeks of immersive study in a chosen subject, with projects, field visits, and guest lectures.

<https://summer.ucla.edu/high-school-students/>

UCLA Game Lab Summer Institute

GRADES 9–12 • COMMUTER • WEST COAST • 2 WEEKS

Game-making as artistic practice — analog and digital game design for students with no prior experience required.

<https://summer.arts.ucla.edu/game-lab>

UMass Amherst

GRADES 9–11 • RESIDENTIAL • NEW ENGLAND • LENGTH VARIES

Pre-college programs combining academics, residence hall living, and trained live-in program assistants.

<https://www.umass.edu/summer/precollege>

University of Chicago

GRADES 9–12 • RESIDENTIAL / COMMUTER / ONLINE • MIDWEST • LENGTH VARIES

Summer Session courses across many disciplines, letting students take intellectual risks beyond the high school curriculum.

<https://summer.uchicago.edu/pre-college/>

University of Delaware

GRADES 10–11 • RESIDENTIAL • MID-ATLANTIC • 5+ WEEKS

The Edge program combines academic coursework, practical skill building, and student leadership on campus.

<https://www.udel.edu/apply/undergraduate-admissions/precollege-programs/edge/>

University of Notre Dame

GRADES 10–12 • RESIDENTIAL / ONLINE • MIDWEST • 2 WEEKS

College-level classes with Notre Dame faculty on campus, abroad, and online, with a leadership and service focus.

<https://precollege.nd.edu/>

University of Pennsylvania

GRADES 9–11 • RESIDENTIAL • MID-ATLANTIC • 3 WEEKS

Three- or six-week Penn Summer High School Programs with Ivy League curriculum and leading faculty.

<https://summer.sas.upenn.edu/programs/high-school>

University of Rochester

GRADES 9–12 • RESIDENTIAL / COMMUTER / ONLINE • NY METRO & WESTCHESTER • LENGTH VARIES

Pre-College Programs letting students explore university resources and sharpen academic skills.

<https://admissions.rochester.edu/pre-college/>

University of Wisconsin–Madison

GRADES 10–11 • RESIDENTIAL / COMMUTER / ONLINE • MIDWEST • LENGTH VARIES

Accelerated Summer Term courses taken with college students, establishing an official UW–Madison transcript.

<https://summer.wisc.edu/highschoolstudents/>

Vanderbilt University

GRADES 7–12 • RESIDENTIAL • SOUTH • LENGTH VARIES

Vanderbilt Summer Academy: residential accelerated courses with Vanderbilt professors and graduate students.

<https://pty.vanderbilt.edu/students/vsa/>

Wake Forest University

GRADES 9–12 • RESIDENTIAL • SOUTH • 1 WEEK

Summer Immersion: one week deep inside a single field of study with faculty and industry professionals.

<https://immersion.summer.wfu.edu/>

Washington University in St. Louis

GRADES 9–12 • RESIDENTIAL / COMMUTER / ONLINE • MIDWEST • LENGTH VARIES

For-credit and noncredit Summer Experience programs with academic and residential support staff.

<https://admissions.washu.edu/college-prep/summer-programs-for-high-school-students/>

Wentworth Institute of Technology

GRADES 10–11 • RESIDENTIAL • NEW ENGLAND • 2 WEEKS

ImpactLab: a two-week residential program exploring engineering, design, and science professions.

<https://wit.edu/precollege>

Worcester Polytechnic Institute

GRADES 10–12 • RESIDENTIAL / COMMUTER • NEW ENGLAND • 2 WEEKS

Launch (commuter) and Frontiers (residential) put students in the shoes of engineers, designers, and scientists.

<https://www.wpi.edu/academics/pre-collegiate/summer-programs>

Visual & Performing Arts

Academy of Art University

GRADES 10–12 • RESIDENTIAL / ONLINE • WEST COAST • 5+ WEEKS

A six-week intensive of up to four classes, online or in San Francisco, across art and design fields.

<https://www.academyart.edu/courses/pre-college-art-experience-interactive-online-orientation/>

AMDA High School Conservatory

GRADES 9–12 • RESIDENTIAL • WEST COAST • LENGTH VARIES

Immersive performing arts training with world-class faculty, audition opportunities, and a final presentation.

<https://www.amda.edu/highschool>

Berklee College of Music

AGES 15+ • RESIDENTIAL / ONLINE • NEW ENGLAND • LENGTH VARIES

Perform in ensembles, develop improvisation and reading skills, and take weekly private lessons.

<https://college.berklee.edu/summer>

Christie's Art Now

GRADES 10-12 • COMMUTER • NY METRO & WESTCHESTER • 1 WEEK

An insider's look at the contemporary art world, with guided visits to galleries, collections, and museums.

<https://education.christies.com/>

Columbus College of Art and Design

GRADES 10-12 • RESIDENTIAL • MIDWEST • LENGTH VARIES

Experience any CCAD major through classes and workshops while living in a residence hall.

<https://www.ccad.edu/academics/college-preview>

Cow House Studios (Ireland)

AGES 15-18 • RESIDENTIAL • ABROAD • 2 WEEKS

Art on the Farm: drawing, painting, photography, and new media alongside practicing artists in rural Ireland.

<https://cowhousestudios.com/programs/summer-art-programs>

Denison Summer TUTTI

AGES 15-18 • RESIDENTIAL • MIDWEST • 2 WEEKS

Performing arts camp for dancers, musicians, and theatre-makers collaborating with professional artists.

<https://summertutti.denison.edu/>

Fashion Institute of Technology

GRADES 9-12 • COMMUTER / ONLINE • NY METRO & WESTCHESTER • LENGTH VARIES

Precollege programs including creative arts portfolio development, on FIT's Manhattan campus.

<https://www.fitnyc.edu/precollege/>

Parsons Paris (online)

GRADES 9-12 • ONLINE • SELF-PACED

Asynchronous online fashion courses taught by Paris-based experts, available year-round at your own pace.

<https://fashionanddesign.precollegeprograms.org/>

Pratt Institute

GRADES 10–12 • RESIDENTIAL / COMMUTER • NY METRO & WESTCHESTER • 4 WEEKS

Choose a major focus plus foundation, art history, and portfolio classes; earn four college credits.

<https://www.pratt.edu/continuing-and-professional-studies/precollege/summer-precollege/>

Purchase College

GRADES 9–12 • COMMUTER • NY METRO & WESTCHESTER • LENGTH VARIES

Precollege arts programs in Westchester offering portfolio building and audition technique training.

<https://www.purchase.edu/academics/youth-and-precollege-programs/>

Rhode Island School of Design

GRADES 10–11 • RESIDENTIAL / COMMUTER / ONLINE • NEW ENGLAND • LENGTH VARIES

Studio work with award-winning faculty to master tools and materials and build an admission portfolio.

<https://precollege.risd.edu/>

SCAD

GRADES 9–12 • RESIDENTIAL / COMMUTER / ONLINE • SOUTH • LENGTH VARIES

Summer programs across art and design disciplines with extensive equipment and facilities.

<https://www.scad.edu/academics/pre-college-summer-programs>

School of Visual Arts

GRADES 9–12 • RESIDENTIAL / COMMUTER • NY METRO & WESTCHESTER • 3 WEEKS

Three-week intensive art school experience in Manhattan, weekdays 9am–4pm, plus evening activities.

<https://sva.edu/academics/pre-college/grades-9-12>

University of Michigan (Stamps)

GRADES 9–11 • RESIDENTIAL / COMMUTER • MIDWEST • 2 WEEKS

Portfolio-building art and design courses with Stamps faculty, in two- and three-week residential studios.

<https://stamps.umich.edu/pre-college>

Language

Middlebury Language Schools

GRADES 9–12 • RESIDENTIAL • NEW ENGLAND • 4 WEEKS

The Academy: language immersion for motivated students wanting to accelerate their skills over a summer.

<https://www.middlebury.edu/language-schools/>

Writing & Journalism

BU Summer Journalism Academy

AGES 14–18 • RESIDENTIAL / ONLINE • NEW ENGLAND • 1 WEEK

Working journalists teach real reporting assignments, residentially on campus or remotely from home.

<https://combeyond.bu.edu/workshop/summer-journalism-academy-bu/>

CSPA High School Journalism Workshop

GRADES 10–12 • COMMUTER • WEST COAST • 1 WEEK

25 students receive hands-on instruction in print, broadcast, online, and photo journalism, plus ethics.

<https://cspaworkshop.org/>

Princeton Summer Journalism Program

GRADES 11 • RESIDENTIAL • MID-ATLANTIC • 1 WEEK • NO COST

An all-expenses-paid 10-day journalism seminar for 35–40 students from low-income backgrounds.

<https://sjp.princeton.edu/>

Reynolds Young Writers Workshop at Denison

GRADES 10–11 • RESIDENTIAL • MIDWEST • 1 WEEK

An eight-day June workshop for rising juniors and seniors who love to write, on Denison's Ohio campus.

<https://reynolds.denison.edu/>

Sarah Lawrence College

GRADES 9–12 • RESIDENTIAL / COMMUTER • NY METRO & WESTCHESTER • LENGTH VARIES

Creative and academic immersion in Westchester, with residential and non-residential options.

<https://www.sarahlawrence.edu/pre-college/>

Simon's Rock at Bard College

GRADES 9–11 • RESIDENTIAL • NEW ENGLAND • 1 WEEK

Young Writers Workshop: informal, expressive writing and peer response leading to polished pieces.

<https://www.simons-rock.edu/>

The School of The New York Times

GRADES 9–12 • RESIDENTIAL / COMMUTER • NY METRO & WESTCHESTER • 2 WEEKS

Two-week courses with Times journalists and expert practitioners across New York City.

<https://nytedu.com/pre-college/summer-academy/nyc/>

Writopia Lab

GRADES 9–12 • COMMUTER / ONLINE • NY METRO & WESTCHESTER • SELF-PACED

Creative writing workshops fostering literacy and critical thinking for teens from all backgrounds.

<https://www.writopialab.org/programs>

STEM & Medicine

2Sigma School

GRADES 9–12 • ONLINE • 5+ WEEKS

Summer of Code: an accredited, project-based computer science course with a live teacher.

<https://2sigma.school/>

AI Camp

GRADES 9–12 • ONLINE • 3 WEEKS

Small online classes (six students per instructor) building an AI product, with no coding experience required.

<https://www.ai-camp.org/>

AwesomeMath

GRADES 9–12 • RESIDENTIAL / ONLINE • SOUTH • 3 WEEKS

An intensive camp for mathematically gifted students preparing for contests like AMC, AIME, and USAMO.

<https://www.awesomemath.org/summer-program/>

Bold Summers × Penn Perelman School of Medicine

GRADES 11–12 • RESIDENTIAL • MID-ATLANTIC • 4 WEEKS

Four weeks modeled on first-year Penn Med classes, with simulations and live demonstrations.

<https://www.boldsummers.com/summer-programs/penn-medicine-summer-program/>

Canada/USA Mathcamp

AGES 13–18 • RESIDENTIAL • MULTIPLE SITES • 5+ WEEKS

Five weeks of undergraduate and graduate-level mathematics in a close community of young mathematicians.

<https://www.mathcamp.org/>

Einstein-Montefiore Summer Research Program

AGES 16–18 • COMMUTER • NY METRO & WESTCHESTER • 5+ WEEKS

A selective five-week, full-time research experience in the Bronx; requires a science teacher recommendation.

<https://einsteinmed.edu/education/phd/summer-hs-research-program>

Health Careers Institute at Dartmouth

GRADES 10–12 • RESIDENTIAL / COMMUTER • NEW ENGLAND • 1 WEEK

Explore health care through visits to clinical settings and conversations with physicians and researchers.

<https://healthsciences.dartmouth.edu/health-careers-institute>

Inspirit AI

GRADES 9–12 • RESIDENTIAL / ONLINE • MULTIPLE SITES • 2 WEEKS

AI applications and ethics across music, ecology, medicine, and robotics, mentored in groups of five.

<https://www.inspiritai.com/>

Inspirit AI Scholars (Live Online)

GRADES 9–12 • ONLINE • 3 WEEKS

A 10-session, 25-hour AI bootcamp taught by graduate students, ending in a socially impactful project.

<https://www.inspiritai.com/liveonline>

InvestIN (London)

AGES 12–18 • RESIDENTIAL / COMMUTER • ABROAD • 1 WEEK

Medical and professional experience programs in London hospitals and clinics, supervised by practitioners.

<https://investin.org/>

Learn with Leaders — Future Doctors

GRADES 8–12 • ONLINE • 1 WEEK

A nine-day, two-weekend online program exploring the pre-medical field and the path to medical school.

<https://learnwithleaders.com/>

Learn with Leaders — Young Tech Leaders

GRADES 9–12 • ONLINE • 1 WEEK

A 10-day online course in procedural programming — variables, conditions, loops, functions, and file I/O.

<https://learnwithleaders.com/>

NASA Internships

GRADES 11–12 • COMMUTER / ONLINE • MULTIPLE SITES • 5+ WEEKS • STIPEND / PAID

Mentor-directed research and operations internships in science and engineering across NASA centers.

<https://www.nasa.gov/learning-resources/internship-programs/>

National Security Agency STEM Program

GRADES 12 • COMMUTER • MID-ATLANTIC • 5+ WEEKS • STIPEND / PAID

A paid summer program for high school seniors with demonstrated aptitude in engineering, math, and science.

<https://www.intelligencecareers.gov/nsa/students-and-internships>

New York Math Circle

GRADES 9–12 • COMMUTER • NY METRO & WESTCHESTER • 3 WEEKS

An intensive three-week weekday program in Manhattan: morning class, afternoon problem-solving sessions.

<https://www.nymathcircle.org/summer>

Rochester +Live (online)

AGES 13+ • ONLINE • SELF-PACED

Year-round online courses with Rochester faculty video and mentor access, at your own pace.

<https://rochesteronline.precollegeprograms.org/>

Leadership

ACLU Summer Institute

GRADES 10-12 • RESIDENTIAL • MID-ATLANTIC • 1 WEEK

An eight-day Washington, D.C. program learning from lawyers, lobbyists, and community activists.

<https://www.aclu.org/2026-aclu-national-advocacy-institute>

Bank of America Student Leaders

GRADES 11-12 • COMMUTER • MULTIPLE SITES • 5+ WEEKS • STIPEND / PAID

A paid summer internship with a local nonprofit plus a national leadership summit in Washington, D.C.

<https://about.bankofamerica.com/en/making-an-impact/student-leaders>

Envision National Youth Leadership Forums

GRADES 9-12 • RESIDENTIAL • MULTIPLE SITES • 1 WEEK

Career, technology, and leadership programs built around real-world challenges and team problem-solving.

<https://www.envisionexperience.com/explore-our-programs/high-school>

LEADing for Life

GRADES 11 • RESIDENTIAL / ONLINE • MULTIPLE SITES • 2 WEEKS

LEADing for Life Institute (LFLI) develops high school students into lifelong learners — a signature approach for moving from high school to college to career.

<https://www.leadingforlife.org/index1.jsp>

Learn with Leaders — Innovation & Entrepreneurship

GRADES 9-12 • ONLINE • 1 WEEK

A two-weekend program on pitching business ideas, market research, and raising investment.

<https://learnwithleaders.com/>

Lehigh University Iacocca Global Entrepreneurship Intensive

AGES 15-17 • RESIDENTIAL • MID-ATLANTIC • 2 WEEKS

Work a real client problem in a culturally diverse group across sustainability, tech, health, or branding.

<https://global.lehigh.edu/iacocca-institute/high-school>

Mercy University Summer Leadership Academy

GRADES 11 • COMMUTER • NY METRO & WESTCHESTER • 1 WEEK

A week-long Westchester program on leadership and business careers taught by executive faculty.

<https://www.mercy.edu/academics/school-business/business-leadership-academy>

The Bronfman Youth Fellowship

GRADES 11 • RESIDENTIAL • ABROAD • 5+ WEEKS • NO COST

26 fellows spend an all-expenses-paid summer in Israel and the U.S. exploring Jewish texts and ideas.

<https://bronfman.org/>

West Point Summer Leaders Experience

GRADES 11 • RESIDENTIAL • NY METRO & WESTCHESTER • 1 WEEK • APPLICATIONS OPEN FEBRUARY 15

A five-day immersion in academic, military, and social life at the U.S. Military Academy.

<https://www.westpoint.edu/admissions/summer-program>

Research

Hofstra University Summer Science Research

GRADES 11-12 • COMMUTER • NY METRO & WESTCHESTER • 5+ WEEKS

July through mid-August research with science faculty, ending in a fall poster session; teacher recommendation required.

<https://www.hofstra.edu/summer/>

Memorial Sloan Kettering Summer Student Program

GRADES 11-12 • COMMUTER • NY METRO & WESTCHESTER • 5+ WEEKS • STIPEND / PAID

Eight weeks conducting original research in a Manhattan lab under a post-doc, with a stipend on completion.

<https://www.mskcc.org/education-training/high-school-college/hopp-summer-student>

Project TRUE (Bronx Zoo)

GRADES 10-11 • COMMUTER • NY METRO & WESTCHESTER • 5+ WEEKS • STIPEND / PAID

Summer and fall field research at the Bronx Zoo with Fordham and WCS scientists; paid stipend or hourly wage.

<https://bronxzoo.com/teens/project-true>

Simons Summer Research Program

GRADES 11 • COMMUTER • NY METRO & WESTCHESTER • 5+ WEEKS • STIPEND / PAID

Hands-on research in science, math, or engineering with faculty mentors at Stony Brook University.

<https://www.stonybrook.edu/simons/>

Internships

GO Project Summer Internship

GRADES 10–12 • COMMUTER • NY METRO & WESTCHESTER • 5+ WEEKS

Five weeks as a teaching assistant in K–5 classrooms, with daily professional development sessions.

<https://goprojectnyc.org/get-involved>

Greenwich Audubon Center

GRADES 10–11 • COMMUTER • NY METRO & WESTCHESTER • 5+ WEEKS

Eco-Leadership Corps: eight weeks of New England ecology, land stewardship, and program design.

<https://www.audubon.org/greenwich/get-involved>

Museum of Arts and Design

GRADES 10–11 • COMMUTER • NY METRO & WESTCHESTER • 5+ WEEKS • STIPEND / PAID

Artslife: a paid internship combining art and design with museum studies and community engagement.

<https://madmuseum.org/learn/teens>

New York Historical

GRADES 10–12 • COMMUTER • NY METRO & WESTCHESTER • 5+ WEEKS • STIPEND / PAID

Student Historians conduct research and build digital public-history projects; \$700 stipend on completion.

<https://www.nyhistory.org/education/student-historian-internship-program>

PENCIL Internship Program

GRADES 11–12 • COMMUTER • NY METRO & WESTCHESTER • 5+ WEEKS • STIPEND / PAID

20+ hours of career readiness training, then a paid six-week internship with a New York City employer.

<https://pencil.org/>

Smithsonian Internships

GRADES 10–12 • COMMUTER / ONLINE • MID-ATLANTIC • LENGTH VARIES

Opportunities across the world's largest museum, education, and research complex.

<https://internships.si.edu/opportunities>

The Metropolitan Museum of Art

GRADES 10–11 • COMMUTER • NY METRO & WESTCHESTER • 5+ WEEKS • STIPEND / PAID

A paid internship working behind the scenes with Museum staff to deepen knowledge of art.

<https://www.metmuseum.org/about-the-met/internships/high-school>

Education, Special Interests & Adventure

Abbey Road Programs

GRADES 9–12 • RESIDENTIAL • ABROAD • 3 WEEKS

Study abroad summer programs built around cross-cultural understanding and academic enrichment.

<https://www.goabbeyroad.com/>

Adventures Cross Country (ARCC)

GRADES 9–12 • RESIDENTIAL • ABROAD • 2 WEEKS

Two- to four-week programs combining service projects with adventure and cultural activities.

<https://www.adventurescrosscountry.com/>

Broadreach

GRADES 9–12 • RESIDENTIAL • ABROAD • 2 WEEKS

Teen dive, sail, and marine biology voyages plus wildlife conservation and veterinary medicine programs.

<https://www.gobroadreach.com/>

Bruce Beck & Ian Eagle Sports Broadcasting Camp

AGES 10–19 • RESIDENTIAL / COMMUTER • NY METRO & WESTCHESTER • 1 WEEK

At Seton Hall's TV and radio studios: writing, on-camera skills, athlete interviews, and control room work.

<https://www.sportsbroadcastingcamp.com/>

CIEE Global Navigator

GRADES 9-12 • RESIDENTIAL • ABROAD • 3 WEEKS

Three to four weeks abroad in 40 destinations across arts, business, language, leadership, and STEM.

<https://www.ciee.org/go-abroad/high-school-study-abroad/summer>

EXPLO

AGES 12-14 • RESIDENTIAL / COMMUTER • NEW ENGLAND • 2 WEEKS

Ungraded, non-credit courses including Expo 360, Medical Rotations, and Veterinary Rotations.

<https://www.explo.org/our-programs/>

Global Leadership Adventures

AGES 14-18 • RESIDENTIAL • ABROAD • 2 WEEKS

Service and leadership programs in Africa, Asia, Europe, and Latin America.

<https://www.experiencegla.com/>

GoBeyond

GRADES 9-12 • RESIDENTIAL • ABROAD • 2 WEEKS

Cross-cultural service adventures combining authentic service projects, adventure, and language skills.

<https://www.gobeyondtravel.com/>

Jacob Burns Film Center

GRADES 9-12 • COMMUTER • NY METRO & WESTCHESTER • 1 WEEK

Pleasantville summer camps in new media, documentary and fiction production, screenwriting, and animation.

<https://burnsfilmcenter.org/education/jbfc-camp/>

Learn with Leaders (Law & Policy)

GRADES 9-12 • ONLINE • 2 WEEKS

Future Lawyers and Policy Making & International Relations programs taught online by Harvard students.

<https://learnwithleaders.com/>

National Geographic Youth Programs

GRADES 9-12 • COMMUTER / ONLINE • MULTIPLE SITES • LENGTH VARIES

Internships, virtual externships, Photo Camp, and online education resources for young explorers.

<https://www.nationalgeographic.org/society/education-resources/>

NOLS

AGES 14–18 • RESIDENTIAL • MULTIPLE SITES • 2 WEEKS

Wilderness leadership expeditions in remote backcountry settings and courses closer to home.

<https://www.nols.edu/en/>

Overland

GRADES 9–12 • RESIDENTIAL • MULTIPLE SITES • 2 WEEKS

Phone-free trips from the Maine Coast and Pacific Northwest to the Rockies and the Alps.

<https://overlandsummers.com/>

Oxbridge Academic Programs

GRADES 8–12 • RESIDENTIAL • ABROAD • 3 WEEKS

Small-group courses in Oxford, Cambridge, Paris, Barcelona, New York, Boston, and Los Angeles.

<https://www.oxbridgeprograms.com/>

Putney Student Travel

GRADES 9–12 • RESIDENTIAL • ABROAD • 3 WEEKS

Immersive travel programs in local cultures, communities, and landscapes around the world.

<https://goputney.com/>

Rustic Pathways

GRADES 9–12 • RESIDENTIAL • ABROAD • 2 WEEKS

Travel and service programs integrating education, travel, and philanthropy with local community partners.

<https://rusticpathways.com/>

SAI Programs

GRADES 11–12 • RESIDENTIAL • ABROAD • 3 WEEKS

College-level coursework abroad for high school and gap-year students, with strong on-site support.

<https://www.saiprograms.com/program-category/high-school-gap/>

SEA Semester

GRADES 10–12 • RESIDENTIAL • NEW ENGLAND • 3 WEEKS

Shore-based oceanography on Cape Cod or an at-sea voyage aboard a sailing research vessel.

<https://sea.edu/programs/high-school-pre-college-programs/>

Summer Discovery

GRADES 9–12 • RESIDENTIAL / ONLINE • MULTIPLE SITES • 2 WEEKS

300+ pre-college courses curated by university academic departments, with a certificate of completion.

<https://www.summerdiscovery.com/>

UCLA School of Theater, Film & Television

GRADES 9–12 • RESIDENTIAL • WEST COAST • 2 WEEKS • SESSION A: JULY 19–31

Media Parks: a two-week intensive on theme parks and their ties to film, TV, and video games, with site visits.

<https://www.tft.ucla.edu/>

Villanova NROTC Summer Seminar

GRADES 12 • RESIDENTIAL • MID-ATLANTIC • 1 WEEK

A four-day, four-night look at Villanova's Naval ROTC program, college life, and the scholarship commitment.

<https://www1.villanova.edu/university/liberal-arts-sciences/programs/nrotc.html>

West Coast Connection

AGES 13–17 • RESIDENTIAL • ABROAD • 2 WEEKS

90+ travel, learn, and volunteer programs across more than 20 countries for teens 13–17.

<https://www.westcoastconnection.com/>

Wilderness Adventures

GRADES 9–12 • RESIDENTIAL • MULTIPLE SITES • 2 WEEKS

Extended wilderness expeditions from the Maine coast and Alaskan glaciers to the Tetons and Great Barrier Reef.

<https://www.wildernessadventures.com/>

When to Apply

September – October	Start a shortlist. Browse by interest and note 6–10 programs you would genuinely enjoy.
November – December	Check each program's website for the application opening date, cost, and financial aid. Ask a teacher early if a recommendation is required.
January – February	Most applications open. Selective research programs and the service academies close earliest.
February – March	Submit. Many pre-college programs admit on a rolling basis, so applying earlier is stronger — especially for housing.
April – May	Confirm your spot, pay deposits, complete health and travel forms, and arrange transportation.
June – August	Attend. Keep notes and contacts; they are useful for college essays and future recommendations.

Talk with your counselor

Your school counselor can help you weigh cost, fit, and how a summer program supports your academic plan. Stop by the Guidance Office or email your counselor to set up a time.